



# KOÇ UNIVERSITY

## GRADUATE SCHOOL OF SCIENCES AND ENGINEERING

### STUDENT HANDBOOK

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## **GRADUATE SCHOOL OF SCIENCES AND ENGINEERING**

### **STUDENT HANDBOOK**

#### **GSSE STRUCTURE**



#### **RESPONSIBILITIES OF GSSE COORDINATOR AND PROGRAM ADMINISTRATORS**

The GSSE Coordinator and Program Administrators are primarily responsible for tracking the academic processes of students. The Administrative Staff is expected to provide leadership and ensure that the responsibilities for graduate studies in the graduate school are properly discharged in accordance with YÖK and KU Graduate Teaching and Learning Rules.

#### **RESPONSIBILITIES OF PROGRAM COORDINATORS**

GSSE program coordinators, who are appointed by the IEC, have a variety of responsibilities related to the administration of graduate programs. Some of these responsibilities may include:

- advising graduate students on academic, personal, and career matters.
- ensuring that the program curriculum is up-to-date and coordinating changes to the curriculum as needed.

- working with faculty members to ensure that the program is delivered in a cohesive manner
- organizing PhD qualification exams and coordinating with the faculty members and students so that the exams are offered every fall and spring semester.

## **RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE STUDENTS**

Students are supposed to read carefully the announcements sent by the GSSE Office. Meeting the deadlines and taking the required actions are the responsibilities of students.

## **GETTING STARTED: WEEK OF ORIENTATION AND WELCOME**

Newcomers' Student Orientation is generally held during the add/drop period of the semester. The detailed information will be sent by GSSE via email.

## **STUDENT KU ID CARDS**

Student KU ID Cards are issued following registration. Students are required to show their ID cards at the main entrance and carry it on campus.

Students also might need their KU ID card for on-campus facilities such as booking a study room, borrowing a book from the library, or getting a locker at the gym etc.

Student KU ID cards are free of charge. However, a fee will be charged in case they are lost.

For lost ID cards, students must first pay the fee to the Yapı Kredi Bank and then go to the security office (**Presidents Building Floor -1**).

## **BANK ACCOUNTS**

In order to receive your monthly stipends, reimbursements of scientific activities, and other cash transactions all students must have a bank account.

Yapı Kredi Bank branch is available on our campus located in the Student Center.

Students must notify the GSSE Office once they activate their bank account by sending their IBAN number via email.

***For international students:***

To open a bank account a student must have a residence permit and/or TAX ID number.

Please contact the International Community Office (ICO) @ [ico@ku.edu.tr](mailto:ico@ku.edu.tr) to inquire about how to obtain a TAX ID number.

**RESIDENCE PERMITS (INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS)**

A residence permit is required of anyone who will stay in Türkiye for longer than **three months** or the amount of time granted through a visa. Therefore, all students are obliged, by law, to apply for and obtain a residence permit upon their arrival in Türkiye.

International Community Office (ICO) supports all students with the residency process.

ICO office is located at the Student Center Lower 3rd Floor, B391 A.

[ICO staff](#)

Email address: [ico@ku.edu.tr](mailto:ico@ku.edu.tr)

For all details on how to apply for or renew a residence permit, please visit [ICO](#) webpage.

**KUSIS/E-MAIL ADDRESS**

You will be able to access your email account using [My KU](#).

All student email accounts are Gmail-based.

When activating your email, you will use your KU ID and you will be notified about your username and password.

## **ISTANBUL CARD**

Istanbulkart is a form of electronic ticketing used instead of cash on public transportation in Istanbul. It can be used on buses, metro, funiculars, tramways, and ferries.

Please visit the website of the [İETT](http://www.iett.net.tr) for details.

## **HEALTH INSURANCE**

All students (full-time) are offered Private Health Insurance (with a limited coverage) as a part of their scholarship.

You will be notified about Health insurance forms by GSSE.

Expense claims should be directly submitted to the HR office located on the ground floor of the President's Building.

## **MEAL CARDS (SETCARD)**

Full-time PhD students may receive monthly meal cards (with limited coverage) as a part of their scholarship.

Meal cards are provided to PhD students one month (approximately) following their registration and will be distributed by the GSSE office. Credits are loaded automatically every month.

For lost cards, please contact [gsse@ku.edu.tr](mailto:gsse@ku.edu.tr)

## **SHUTTLE & BUS SCHEDULE**

[Transportation services](#)

## **PARKING & HGS**

HGS (Fast Transit Pass) stickers are provided free of charge for the PhD students (only). Stickers can be obtained from the **HGS sticker registration office** located at the Student Center, Third Basement (-3) Room B 344. [Traffic regulations](#) apply to everyone on campus.

## **PRINTING**

For each semester, a printing quota is allowed for MS and PhD students. A credit for printing is uploaded by IT automatically at the beginning of every semester (Spring, Fall, Summer).

For more information please visit [here](#).

## **KEY PEOPLE/OFFICES**

**GSSE Office:** ENG 210

**Email:** [gsse@ku.edu.tr](mailto:gsse@ku.edu.tr)

**Academic & Administrative Coordinator:** Emine Büyükdurmuş - [ebuyukdurmus@ku.edu.tr](mailto:ebuyukdurmus@ku.edu.tr)  
- +90 212 338 1396

**Institute Administrative Assistant:** Zehra Puntar Özkonuk - [zpuntar@ku.edu.tr](mailto:zpuntar@ku.edu.tr) - +90 212 338 1371

## **INTERNATIONAL STUDENT REQUIREMENTS**

**Contact Person:** Melissa Abache - [mabache@ku.edu.tr](mailto:mabache@ku.edu.tr) - +90 212 338 1178

[The Office of International Programs \(OIP\)](#)

## **PLACES**

[Registrar's Office](#), [Information Technology \(IT\)](#), [Health Center](#), [Library](#), [Dean of Students](#), [KUHub](#)



## **STUDENT HEALTH AND COUNSELING SERVICES (SHCS)**

Students can consult the Counseling Services when they would like to receive psychological support or psychological counseling. More information can be found [here](#).

## **EMERGENCY NUMBERS**

- Health Center Emergency / Sağlık Merkezi Acil: 11 22
- Health Center Reception – Appointment / Sağlık Merkezi Resepsiyon-Randevu: (0212) 338-1273
- Health Center Fax / Sağlık Merkezi Fax: (0212) 338-1272
- Public Hospital Emergency / Devlet Acil Ambulansı: (0212) 338-112
- Amerikan Hospital / Amerikan Hastanesi: (0212) 311 20 00
- Security Office Emergency / Güvenlik Ofisi Acil: (0212) 338 3535 – 338 3636 – 338 3060

## **TUITION, FEES, AND FINANCES**

### **GSSE FINANCIAL AID OPTIONS**

There exists a wide spectrum of financial aid and scholarship opportunities and packages for graduate students at the GSSE. These include the “KU Graduate Fellowship” funded by Koç University and the “Project-based Graduate Scholarship” co-funded by external sources such as TÜBİTAK, EU, industry through projects, and Koç University.

### **KU Graduate Fellowship**

KU Graduate Fellowship is a competitive MS and PhD scholarship opportunity. Applicants having an excellent academic record and/or having high-impact scientific publications are

considered for KU Graduate Fellowship. KU Graduate Fellowship includes the following stipend & benefits:

### **Project-based Graduate Scholarship**

MS and PhD students are accepted to participate in specific research projects funded by external sources such as TÜBİTAK, EU, or industry. The stipend varies depending on the project. Koç University provides the same benefits for all Project-based Graduate Scholarships.

### **TÜBİTAK 2244 Industrial PhD Program Scholarship**

TÜBİTAK 2244 Industrial PhD Program is aiming for the training of qualified students in collaboration with the industry. For more details, please visit the TÜBİTAK website.

### **TÜBİTAK BİDEB Scholarship**

Koç University expects that all KU full-scholarship students should apply for the TÜBİTAK BİDEB graduate scholarship program. Students who receive the TÜBİTAK BİDEB scholarship will be responsible for providing all the requirements and paperwork related to the contract by themselves.

### **Tuition Waiver Only Scholarships**

MS and PhD students accepted with a “Tuition Waiver” will be exempt from the annual tuition fee. The tuition waiver scholarship does not include any side benefits.

### **AI Fellowships**

The AI fellowship is awarded to qualified MS and PhD students. Students follow the regular graduate school application process, there is no separate application for the fellowship. The fellowship candidates are nominated by the faculty and recipients are determined by a written exam and an in-person interview. The fellowship exam is a take-home exam testing basic mathematics (probability, linear algebra) and programming skills.

### **Türkiye Scholarships for International PhD Applicants**

Türkiye Scholarship is a government-funded higher education scholarship program run by the Republic of Türkiye for international students. To receive the scholarship students need to do the following in parallel with the relevant application periods:

- apply to Koç University using the [online application system “Dreamapply”](#)
- if offered admission, then create an application in the [Türkiye Scholarships Application Portal](#) and upload the required documents to activate the scholarship.

The Turkish Scholarships PhD Scholarship is only eligible for Fall semester international admitted students to Koç University’s PhD programs. All countries are eligible for this scholarship.

### **Fung Graduate Fellowship for Applicants from China**

The Fung Fellowship Program at Koç University is a joint scholarship program between Koç University and the Victor and Willian Fung Foundation. It provides full scholarships for 6 high-achieving students from China to pursue their PhD degrees at any of Koç University’s PhD programs every year. More information about this scholarship opportunity can be found [here](#).

### **HEC Pakistan Scholarship**

The HEC Pakistan Scholarship Program at Koç University is a joint scholarship program between Koç University and the Higher Education Council (HEC) of Pakistan. It provides full scholarships for high-achieving students from Pakistan to pursue their MS-leading to PhD and PhD degrees at any of Koç University’s research graduate programs. To get more information you can use this link. More information about this scholarship opportunity can be found [here](#).

### **Payment of Stipends**

The duration of the payments is indicated in your offer letter. KU stipends are paid at the beginning of the month while payments of externally funded projects are made at the end of the month.

The details of financial aid packages offered by GSSE can be found [here](#).

## **ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS /PROCESSES**

### **PROGRAM REQUIREMENTS**

#### **PhD Programs**

**Period of study:** The duration of the PhD program, regardless of which semesters the student has registered for, is at least eight and at most twelve semesters for students accepted with a MS degree, and at least ten and at most fourteen semesters for students accepted with a BS degree. Students who do not complete the program within this duration will be dismissed from the program.

**Required courses:** PhD Students with an MS degree must take a minimum of 7 courses (minimum 21 credits) and a 3.00/4.00 GPA is the minimum requirement for graduation. PhD Students with a BS degree must take a minimum of 14 courses (minimum 42 credits) and a 3.00 GPA is the minimum requirement for graduation.

PhD students cannot take any undergraduate courses to have them counted in their credit requirements. They can only audit undergraduate courses, the add/drop form for auditing an undergraduate course must be filled out and submitted to Registrar's Office after getting approval of advisor and course instructor.

Additionally, students are required to take the following non-credit courses:

- ENGL 500: Academic Writing

- TEAC 500: Teaching Experience (non-credit, required every semester). Those students who are assigned to a course as a TA must enroll in the TEAC 500 course through KUSIS until the add/drop is over. The students should first find the instructor of the TAship course on KUSIS and select the necessary section.
- “PROGRAM” 695: Thesis Course (non-credit, required every semester)
- “PROGRAM” 590: Seminar Course (at least 1 seminar course but some programs may require more than once). PhD students with an MS degree must complete the seminar course by their 4<sup>th</sup> semester in the program at the latest. PhD students with a BS degree must complete the seminar course by their 6<sup>th</sup> semester in the program at the latest.
- KOLT 600: Training Course for Graduate Teaching (non-credit, required to be completed before the assignment as a TA)
- ETHR 500: Scientific Research Methods and Research and Publication Ethics
- LIBR 500: Library Researcher Development Course for Graduate Students
- Independent Study (INDEP): PhD students with an MS degree can take 1 independent study course; a PhD student with a BS degree can take 2 independent study courses. Independent Study course is not a regularly scheduled university course, but is arranged, planned and managed by a supervising professor in conjunction with the goals that are proposed by the student, and then refined and approved by the supervising professor.

**A grade of C– and below is considered a fail for PhD programs.**

**Period of completing courses:** PhD students with a MS degree must complete all courses (min. 7 courses and 21 credits) and seminar course by their 4<sup>th</sup> semester in the program, latest. PhD students with a BS degree must complete all courses (min. 14 courses and 42 credits) and seminar course by their 6<sup>th</sup> semester in the program, latest.

**Timeline:** All PhD students in graduate programs are assigned thesis advisor no later than the end of the student’s 2<sup>nd</sup> semester in the program.

After **completing the courses** and required credits, **the PhD Qualifying Examination** jury must be assigned. The date of the PhD Qualifying Examination is determined by program coordinators. Students who are accepted with a BS degree must take the qualifier exam by the end of the seventh semester at the latest. Students who are accepted with an MS degree must take the qualifier exam by the end of the fifth semester at the latest. Students who will take the qualifying exam are supposed to complete their credits and course requirements before taking the exam.

The qualifying exam consists of two parts, written and oral. Students who pass the written part can take the oral part. Students who fail the exam in the first attempt have to retake the exam in the following semester. Students who pass the written part but fail the oral part may not be required to repeat the written part and can take the oral part in the following semester. Students who fail the exam in the second attempt are dismissed from the program.

PhD Qualifying Examinations are arranged and carried out by a jury consisting of five members who are recommended by the department board and approved by the IEC. The exam jury consists of five faculty members, including the thesis advisor, and at least two members from a university other than the one they are affiliated with. Qualifying Exam Jury appointment forms must be submitted to GSSE by the announced deadline.

After passing the written part and setting the oral exam date, students/advisors need to inform GSSE about the oral exam date. The exam minutes must be prepared and submitted to the GSSE Office one day before the oral exam at the latest.

The jury members evaluate the performances of the student in written and oral parts and decide, on the basis of absolute majority, whether the student has succeeded or failed. Exam minute with the original signatures of the jury members is submitted to the GSSE Office in three days, following the qualifying exam.

A **PhD Thesis Monitoring Committee** is appointed on the recommendation of the program coordinator and approval of the IEC within one month after the student passes the PhD Qualifying Examination. The Thesis Monitoring Committee is comprised of three faculty

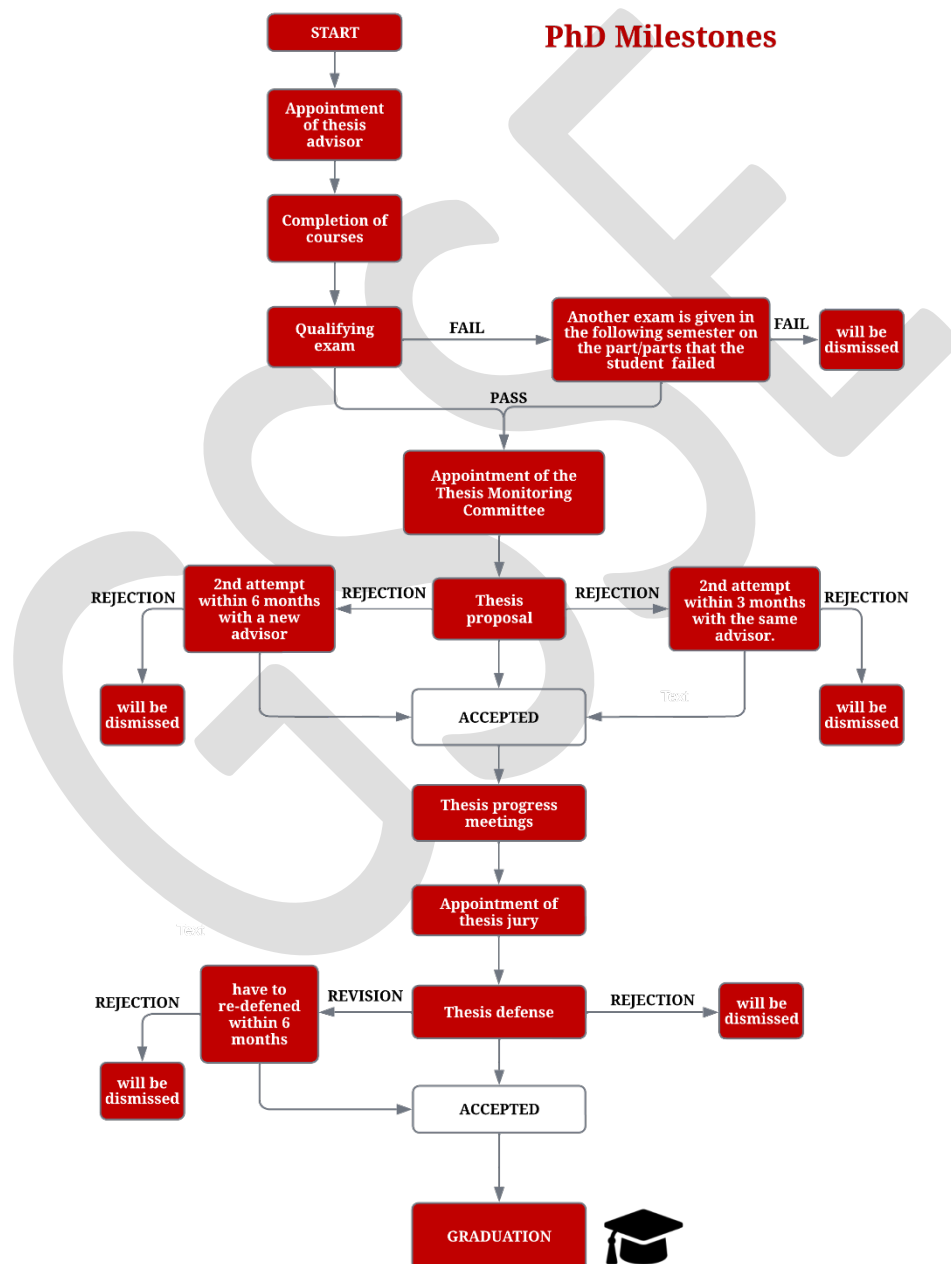
members. Except for the thesis advisor, there must be one member from the program of the student, and one member from outside the program. If there is a co-advisor, the co-advisor may attend the committee meetings without having the right to vote. Once established, the Thesis Monitoring Committee Appointment Form must be submitted to the GSSE office.

The **PhD thesis proposal** is submitted and evaluated within 6 months after the PhD Qualifying Examination. The student must submit the thesis proposal to the members of the PhD Thesis Monitoring Committee 2 weeks before the meeting. Additional meetings can be scheduled to evaluate the PhD thesis proposal.

The Thesis Monitoring Committee for the students whose thesis proposal is accepted meets twice a year; January-June and July-December. The advisor of PhD students is expected to track the schedule of these meetings. The student conducts a presentation at the meeting with the thesis monitoring committee and/or submits a report that includes a summary of the work performed during the evaluation period and a work plan for the next period is provided. Students should submit the progress report to the Thesis Monitoring Committee at most 1 week prior to their meetings. At least three thesis monitoring committee reports with original signatures must be submitted to the GSSE Office within three days following the date of the meeting in order for a student to complete a thesis. Students whose written reports are evaluated as unsatisfactory by the committee two consecutive times, or a total of three times during the thesis work, are dismissed from the program.

A **PhD Thesis Defense Jury** is appointed on the recommendation of the department board and with the approval of the IEC. The jury consists of five members, including the student's advisor, other two members of the PhD Thesis Monitoring Committee, and at least two members from a university other than the one they are affiliated with. The co-advisor may be present in the jury without having the right to vote. A copy of the whole thesis including the thesis submission form must be given to all thesis jury members at least 10 days before the **PhD thesis defense date**. All thesis copies are required to be scanned through Turnitin. The student must submit a plagiarism program report to the jury members and must get their signatures on the thesis submission form. The thesis defense takes place in an environment where faculty members,

graduate students, and field experts are able to participate. After the thesis defense presentation, a question&answer session is organized to receive questions from the participants. At the end of this period, participants other than the jury members leave the room, and the jury directs the student questions about his / her thesis. Finally, jury members complete the evaluation, and the thesis defense is concluded.





Required forms can be found [here](#).

### **MS Programs (thesis)**

**Period of study:** The duration of the MS program, regardless of which semesters the student has registered for, is four semesters, starting from the period in which the courses for the registered program are given. It can be extended for two more semesters; and should be completed in six semesters at most. Students who do not complete the program by the end of the sixth semester are dismissed.

**Required courses:** MS students must take a minimum of 7 courses (minimum 21 credits) and a 3.00/4.00 GPA is the minimum requirement for graduation.

Students of MS with thesis programs may take 2 undergraduate courses (3XX or 4XX) at most with the approval of their academic advisor/program coordinators and with the consent of the instructor of the course to have them counted in their credit requirements. The registration for undergraduate courses requires filling out the course add/drop form.

MS students can audit undergraduate courses, the add/drop form for auditing an undergraduate course must be submitted.

Additionally, students are required to take the following non-credit courses:

- ENGL 500: Academic Writing
- TEAC 500: Teaching Experience (non-credit, required every semester). Those students who are assigned to a course as a TA must enroll in the TEAC 500 course through KUSIS until the add/drop is over. The students should first find the instructor of the TAship course on KUSIS and select the necessary section.
- “PROGRAM” 595: Thesis Course (non-credit, required every semester)

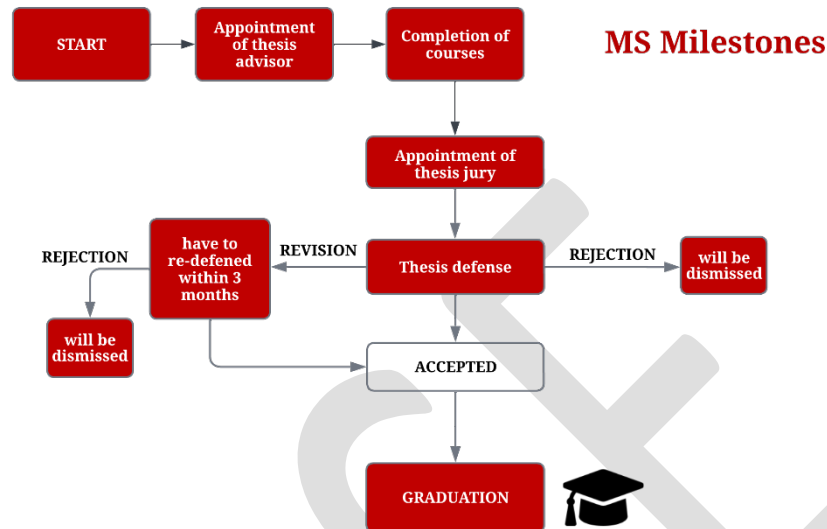
- “PROGRAM” 590: Seminar Course (at least 1 seminar course but some programs may require more than once). MS students must complete the seminar course by their 4<sup>th</sup> semester in the program at the latest.
- KOLT 500: Training Course for Graduate Teaching (non-credit, required to be completed before the assignment as a TA)
- ETHR 500: Scientific Research Methods and Research and Publication Ethics
- LIBR 500: Library Researcher Development Course for Graduate Students
- Independent Study (INDEP): MS students can take 1 independent study course. Independent study course is not a regularly scheduled university course, but is arranged, planned and managed by a supervising professor in conjunction with the goals that are proposed by the student, and then refined and approved by the supervising professor.

**A grade of C– and below is considered a fail for MS programs.**

**Period of completing courses:** MS students (thesis) must complete all courses (min. 7 courses and 21 credits) and seminar course by their 4<sup>th</sup> semester in the program, latest.

**Timeline:** All MS students are assigned a thesis advisor who is appointed by the GSSE no later than the end of the student’s 1<sup>st</sup> semester in the program. After the appointment of the advisor, MS students must submit their **thesis proposal** to the graduate office no later than the end of the 2<sup>nd</sup> semester. After **completing the courses** and credits, **the thesis defense jury** must be assigned. MS thesis jury members are assigned with the recommendation of the thesis advisor and the relevant department board with the approval of the IEC. Jury members are comprised of three or five faculty members, one of them being the thesis advisor, and at least one jury member from a university other than the one they are affiliated with. If a jury committee is comprised of three members, the co-advisor cannot be a jury member. A copy of the whole thesis including the thesis submission form must be given to all thesis jury members at least 1 week before the MS thesis defense date. All thesis copies are required to be scanned through

Turnitin. The student must submit a plagiarism program report to the jury members and must get their signatures on the thesis submission form.



[MS Thesis Proposal Form](#)

### **MS Programs (non-thesis)**

**Period of study:** The duration of the non-thesis MS program, regardless of which semesters the student has registered for, is two semesters, starting from the period in which the courses for the registered program are given and it should be completed in three semesters at most. Students who do not complete the program by the end of the third semester are dismissed.

**Required Courses:** Non-thesis MS students must take a minimum of 10 courses (minimum 30 credits) and a 3.00/4.00 GPA is the minimum requirement for graduation.

Non-thesis MS students may take 3 undergraduate courses (3XX or 4XX) at most with the approval of their academic advisor/program coordinators and with the consent of the instructor of the course to have them counted in their credit requirements. The registration for undergraduate courses requires filling out the course add/drop form.

Additionally, students are required to take the following non-credit courses:

- ENGL 502: Effective Writing and Presentation
- ETHR 500: Scientific Research Methods and Research and Publication Ethics.
- “PROGRAM” 591: Project Course

**Except for some non-thesis programs, a grade of C– and below is considered a fail for graduate programs.**

**Period of completing courses:** MS students (non-thesis) must complete all courses (min. 10 courses and 30 credits) and project course by their 3<sup>th</sup> semester in the program, latest.

**Timeline:** Non-thesis MS programs are comprised of at least ten courses with a term project course. Students must register for the term project course should submit a written project report at the end of the semester. The term project does not have any credit and is evaluated as either “satisfactory” or “unsatisfactory”. For each student, the department board assigns, latest at the end of the first semester, a faculty member or a member of the teaching staff who has the required qualifications specified by the Academic Council and holds a PhD degree, to supervise the student during the course selection and the execution of the term project.

## **HOW TO REGISTER FOR COURSES**

New students enroll in courses during the add/drop period. Please see [Academic Calendar](#) for dates. All existing students plan and enroll in courses following the registrar's announcement.

[KUSIS Enrolment Tips & Tricks](#)

[KUSIS How-To](#)

## **SELECTING COURSES**

All graduate students are encouraged to meet with their academic advisor and program coordinator to plan their course schedules before course registration. Newly admitted students

are encouraged to review course offerings through the websites of the related graduate programs.

All registered students should be able to see the list of the courses offered in related semesters on KUSIS.

All course registrations are done through KUSIS, **except** for undergraduate course registrations. Undergraduate courses are added during the add/drop period. The students must submit a petition to GSSE with the approval of their academic advisor.

A student who does not register for a course will fall into a non-students status. Even if a student has completed all course requirements, he/she must enroll in a Thesis Course every semester (THESIS 595 for MS students, THESIS 695 for PhD Students).

### **ADDING/DROPPING COURSES**

With the approval of the advisor and the instructors of the courses, students can change, add or drop courses during the Add/Drop dates announced in the [Academic Calendar](#). Dropping a course must be done by the add/drop deadline stated in the Academic Calendar for that semester. After the add/drop deadline, the courses cannot be dropped.

If a student drops a course, the course will not be included on the transcript.

### **WITHDRAWAL**

After the add-drop period is over, students can withdraw from a course until the withdrawal deadline stated on the [Academic Calendar](#). Students may withdraw from a course at their own discretion. They must, as a courtesy, notify their instructor and the advisor of their intention, and obtain the withdrawal petition.

If a student withdraws from a course, the course will be included on the transcript with a 'W.' This 'W' indicates that the student attempted the course but eventually withdrew prior to completing the course for a letter grade. 'W's do not count towards a student's GPA.

## **AUDITING A COURSE**

Officially enrolled graduate students who have obtained approval of their advisor and the instructor of the course concerned may audit courses; however, the student will not receive credit for courses scheduled on an auditing basis.

If the student has successfully completed the audit course the grade will be appearing as “AU” on their transcripts. No credit will be granted, and this grade will not affect the GPA. Courses with an AU grade will not contribute to the minimum credit requirements of any degree program.

Requests to audit a course will be granted only if space is available in the course and permission has been given by the instructor of the course and student advisor.

In order for a successful audit to show on the student's permanent record, the student must comply with all requirements listed by the instructor. If the instructor deems that the student did not successfully audit the course, the course will not be appearing on the transcript of the student.

**After enrollment, the status of the course with credits can neither be converted to audit status at any time, nor can audited course be converted to a credit.**

## **LANGUAGE COURSES**

All graduate students may take language courses of their choice or depending on requirements of their program. Language courses, however, are not considered as a part of degree requirements.

## **TAKING COURSES FROM DIFFERENT DEPARTMENTS AND/OR UNIVERSITIES**

MS/PhD students can take courses from other relevant graduate programs offered at KU or other Universities with the approval of their advisors and the program coordinators.

## **CHANGING AN ADVISOR**

Students may change their advisor during their studies in exceptional conditions. This is subject to the approval of the IEC. Required forms can be found at the GSSE Website.

The advisor whose advisee does not continue the program is required to inform the GSSE office.

## **LEAVE OF ABSENCE (LOA)**

**Personal LoA:** Students who find it necessary to interrupt their studies may request a personal LoA by submitting a petition through KUSIS. Students should be aware of the following when requesting a personal LoA:

- Students must apply for LoA with a petition in which they state their excuse by the deadline of the course add/drop period latest (please see the deadline in the Academic Calendar) for the semester related to GSSE.
- Requests for a LoA must be approved in advance by the student advisor and the GSSE.
- Once the LoA request is approved, the student will be unenrolled from the courses, with a notation of “L” for those courses on their transcript.
- The minimum time frame for an LoA is one semester. Students wishing to extend their LoA beyond the original timeframe must contact the GSSE in writing and include the reasons for the extension request.
- Students returning from LoA must notify the GSSE in order to be registered and return to active status.

**Medical LoA:** Students who need to interrupt their studies due to a medical or mental health issue may request a medical LoA by submitting the LoA Request petition with the necessary documents (medical health report). Students should be aware of the following when requesting a medical LoA.

- Students who request a medical LoA after the add/drop deadline but prior to or after the withdrawal deadline (please see the deadline in the [Academic Calendar](#)) will be unenrolled from their courses, with a notation of “L” for those courses on their transcript.

**Academic leave without freezing semester:** Students who will be absent due to academic reasons and will not freeze their semester need to get approval from the GSSE Office. A request stating the destination, dates, and reason for the leave request must be submitted via KUSIS.

## **VACATIONS**

With the exception of official holidays during which the University is also on holiday, graduate students are expected to be on campus and to continue their work and are also expected to successfully complete their TEAC 500 responsibilities, which is part of their education and will prepare them for their academic and research positions following graduation. Graduate students can request vacation with a petition, and upon securing the approval of their advisors. They can be on vacation for a maximum of two weeks during those semesters where they do not have TEAC 500 responsibilities. Vacation requests that fall outside of these semesters are decided on by IEC.

## **LEAVING THE UNIVERSITY**

Students can apply to the GSSE Office on their own will and can request to leave the graduate program. In order to leave the University, students must have completed the procedures established by the University.

## **COURSE TRANSFER / EXEMPTION**

When students request to transfer any course or to be exempted from any course, they submit a petition via KUSIS, including the details of their request and additional required documents (transcript, syllabus, etc.). Upon approval of the academic advisor and the IEC, the student may transfer the credits into his/her degree program. Here are some important rules for the process:



- If the students have taken a course during their previous degrees, they can be exempted from that course, and they need to take another course with the same credit for the replacement of it.
- Up to 4 courses (12 graduate credits) may be transferred to a MS degree that requires 7 courses (21 credits), and up to 6 courses (18 graduate credits) may be transferred to a non-thesis MS degree that requires 10 courses (30 credits). Up to 4 courses (12 graduate credits) may be transferred to a PhD degree that requires 7 courses (21 credits) and 8 courses (24 credits) may be transferred to a direct PhD degree that requires 14 courses (42 credits).
- No graduate credits will be accepted as transfer credits toward a subsequent PhD/MS program if the credits have been applied toward a previously completed PhD/MS degree at any other university. If a course is counted for a previously completed PhD/MS degree and is equivalent to a required course in the program student can only be exempted from the required course. If a course is not counted for a previously completed PhD/MS degree this course can be both transferred and exempted.
- Graduate courses to be transferred from another university to any MS/PhD degree must not have been used to satisfy the requirements for a BS degree, MS degree (or equivalent), or a PhD degree.
- Courses taken on a pass/fail or satisfactory/unsatisfactory basis will not be included in transfer credit.
- Grades earned on transferred courses must be equivalent to B or better.
- A student who wishes to take courses at another university must first consult his/her academic advisor and needs to get approval from GSSE Office by creating a request via KUSIS. According to the YÖK legislation, MS and PhD with a MS degree students can take 2 courses, and PhD students with a BS degree can take 4 courses at most. Once such course credit is earned, they need to submit a petition via KUSIS with the transcript.

## **TA/RA RESPONSIBILITIES OF STUDENTS**

TAs and RAs are integral parts of the teaching and research activities at the university and the participation of graduate students in these activities contributes to their training as strong academicians. Thus, TA and RA tasks are not considered as an exchange for the scholarship. Therefore, all MS (thesis) and PhD students are required to perform TA-RA tasks, regardless of their funding source (e.g., TÜBİTAK, EU, industrial project grant) or lack of it (i.e. tuition waiver). Only students in the non-thesis MS programs are exempt from TA-RA tasks.

TAs and RAs can contribute to teaching and research in a variety of ways depending on the needs of particular courses and research projects. The instructor of the TA course and advisor of the graduate students are expected to keep track of their TA-RA tasks and to ensure that they have successfully fulfilled their duties.

If the student has successfully completed his/her TA duties, the relevant course instructor must enter his/her TEAC 500 course grade as S (Satisfactory), and if the student has not completed his/her TA duties, the course instructor must enter his/her TEAC 500 course grade as U (Unsatisfactory). GSSE collects the TA needs of programs from program coordinators based on the requests of faculty members. After TAs are assigned to a course, no changes can be made. Students can be assigned to different tasks given by other faculty members and instructors. Students assigned to different labs/faculty members as TAs must choose the section of that faculty member/instructor for the TEAC 500 course and this course is graded by the same faculty member/instructor.

RA duties are integral parts of the university and academic development of graduate students. These activities are based on the academic research of students and are evaluated each semester by their advisors. If the student has successfully completed his/her RA duties, the advisor must enter his/her 595/695 Thesis Course grade as S (Satisfactory), and if the student has not completed his/her RA duties, the advisor must enter his/her 595/695 Thesis Course grade as U (Unsatisfactory).

The tuition waiver status, scholarship, and/or other benefits of the students who receive a “U” grade in either TA/RA duties in 2 successive semesters will be terminated.

The tuition waiver, scholarship and/or other benefits of the students who receive a “U” grade in either TA/RA duties in 2 successive semesters will be terminated.

## **DOCUMENTS AND OTHER REQUESTS**

### **HOW TO REQUEST TRANSCRIPTS**

All transcripts are directly requested from Registrar via KUSIS.

<https://registrar.ku.edu.tr/en/general-informations/how-to-videos/#1490439885667-9f3045b3-9b74>

### **HOW TO REQUEST PETITIONS AND OFFICIAL LETTERS**

Visa/Consulate Letters, documents requested by TÜBİTAK etc. could be prepared for students. [Requests](#) are submitted to the GSSE office via KUSIS.

### **HOW TO REQUEST SUPPORT FOR SCIENTIFIC ACTIVITIES**

Graduate students who present a paper or poster at a scientific event are eligible for travel support once a year. **Travel support is a fixed amount that is determined annually.**

The event must take place while the student is enrolled full-time in a graduate degree program.

For application and reimbursement details, please review the instructions provided below;

#### **Application Procedure:**

The application must be submitted prior to the conference, **a minimum of one month in advance of the travel date.** Students must apply with the following documents to the GSSE Office:

- [Travel Fund Application Form](#) signed by student's advisor.
- A copy of the acceptance letter
- technical program showing the paper.
- short CV including the publication list.

Decisions for funding will be announced within 10 days of the submission application.

### **Reimbursement to Student**

Applications for reimbursement will be accepted only after travel is completed. Eligible expenses may include:

- travel (economy class airfare, train, bus ... tickets)
- accommodation
- conference registration
- meals

Students must submit original, itemized, and dated receipts for all expenses. For air travel, original or e-tickets with passenger itinerary/receipt and original boarding passes issued are required.

More information regarding Support for Scientific Activities form can be found [here](#).

## **RULES AND REGULATIONS**

### **GSSE REGULATIONS**

All the faculty members, particularly those who advise students, are expected to read and know the rules and regulations given below. All the rules and regulations can be found on the GSSE Website.

[KU Graduate Student Scholarship Regulations for students enrolled before Fall 2016](#)

[KU Graduate Student Scholarship Regulations for students enrolled as of Fall 2016](#)

[Koç University Regulation for Graduate Teaching and Learning](#)

## **OTHER REGULATIONS**

[Koç University Discipline Rules and Regulations](#)

[Koç University Housing Rules and Regulations](#)

## **GRADUATION**

Please click [here](#) to have more information about the graduation process.

## **COMMENCEMENT**

Koç University Commencement is generally held in mid-June.

## **KU ALUMNI**

<https://mezun.ku.edu.tr/>

## **SOME USEFUL LINKS**

[GSSE Rules and Regulations](#)

[How to Videos](#)

[YÖK Regulations](#)

[European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity](#)

| YÖK REGULATIONS (enforced on April 20th, 2016 and is effective for those students ADMITTED IN AND AFTER 2016 FALL)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NOTES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>DURATION of STUDY</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Max. 3 years (6 semesters)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Students exceeding the maximum durations will be <u>dismissed</u> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| MS Non-Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Max. 1.5 years (3 semesters)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Max. 6 years (12 semesters)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Max. 7 years (14 semesters)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>COMPLETION of COURSES</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Must complete all courses (min. 7 courses and 21 credits and seminar course) latest by 4th semester.                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>MS with thesis students</b> may take two, <b>MS non-thesis students</b> may take three undergraduate courses at most (3XX or 4XX) to count towards their course credit with the approval of their advisors and the instructor of the course.<br><b>PhD students</b> cannot take undergraduate courses to fulfill their course requirements. Undergraduate courses can be audited only.<br><b>Must have a min. GPA of 3.00/4.00.</b><br>Students who do not complete the courses on time will be <u>dismissed</u> from the university.          |
| MS Non-Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Must complete all courses (min. 10 courses and 30 credits) latest by 3rd semester.                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Must complete all courses (min. 7 courses and 21 credits and seminar course) latest by 4th semester.                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Must complete all courses (min. 14 courses and 42 credits and seminar course) latest by 6th semester.                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>STUDENTS WHO COULD NOT COMPLETE THE COURSES SUCCESSFULLY DURING THE ABOVE PERIODS WILL BE DISMISSED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>TAKING THE COURSES FROM OTHER UNIVERSITIES</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis only                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Max. 2 courses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Only with the advisor, program coordinator and Director approval.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Max. 2 courses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Max. 4 courses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>APPOINTMENT of THESIS ADVISOR</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis and Non-Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | No later then the end of <u>1st semester</u> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | *Must at least hold a Asst. Prof. Title for the MS with Thesis students.<br>*Must at least hold a PhD title for the MS with Non-Thesis students.<br>*The PhD thesis advisors must have at least supervised one MS thesis before supervising a PhD Thesis.<br>*If necessary the co-advisor can be outside of the university holding at least a PhD degree                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | No later then the end of <u>2nd semester</u> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>QUALIFYING EXAM (PhD only)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Must take the qualifying exam latest by <u>5th semester</u> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | *Qualifying exam must be in two parts; written and oral and offered twice a year.<br>*5 jury members; at least 2 non-KU.<br>*All members of this committee must be affiliated with a University or Academic Institution and must at least hold an Asst. Prof. Degree.<br>* <u>Qualifier Exam Jury Appointment form</u> must be submitted to GSSE 1 week before the exam at latest.                                                                                                                                                                |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Must take the qualifying exam latest by <u>7th semester</u> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>STUDENTS WHO FAIL THE SECOND ATTEMPT OF THE QUAL EXAM WILL BE DISMISSED (WILL BE APPLIED TO THOSE STUDENTS ADMITTED IN AND AFTER FALL 2016).</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>APPOINTMENT OF THESIS MONITORING COMMITTEE</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Must be appointed within one (1) month after passing the qualifying exam.                                                                                                                                                                                                           | * 3 Faculty Members: Thesis advisor + 1 member from the program + 1 member outside the program. All committee members must be affiliated with a University or an Academic Institution and must at least hold an Asst. Prof. Degree.<br>*Students must hold min. 3 meetings in order to graduate.<br>* <u>Thesis Monitoring Committee Assignment form</u> must be submitted to GSSE.                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>THESIS PROPOSAL</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>No later then the end of <u>2nd semester</u>.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                       | * The subject of the thesis specified by the thesis advisor and by the students should be proposed until the <u>2nd semester</u> latest to GSSE.<br>* All master students must submit the <u>Thesis Proposal form</u> to GSSE.<br><br>*If proposal is rejected;<br>➤ makes a 2nd attempt within 3 months w/the same advisor, within 6 months w/new advisor.<br><br>*If unsuccessful again, student will be <u>dismissed</u> .<br>* All PhD students must submit the <u>Thesis Proposal form</u> and to GSSE within 3 days after the presentation. |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>6 months after passing the qualifier exam <u>latest</u>.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>THESIS MONITORING MEETINGS</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Students must hold at least 3 thesis monitoring meetings before graduation.</li><li>Students who fail the thesis monitoring meetings in two consecutive terms or three non-consecutive terms will be dismissed from the university.</li></ul> | * Meetings start 6 months after the proposal defense. Progresses tracked at least twice a year and at least once between January-June and once between July-December.<br>* All students must submit the <u>Thesis Monitoring form</u> to GSSE within 3 days after the presentations.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>APPOINTMENT OF THESIS JURY</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MS with Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>The jury consists of 3 or 5 faculty members including the student's advisor, at least one (1) member from another university.</li></ul>                                                                                                       | * Jury members must have min. Asst. Prof title.<br>* If the jury is comprised of three members, co-advisor cannot be a jury member.<br>* <u>Thesis Jury Appointment form</u> must be submitted to GSSE 1 week before the exam at latest.<br><br>*Jury members must have min. Asst. Prof title.<br>*Co-advisor can be in the jury without having the right to vote.<br>* <u>Thesis Jury Appointment form</u> must be submitted to GSSE 10 days before the exam at latest.                                                                          |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>The jury consists of five (5) faculty members including the student's advisor, three of them the thesis monitoring committee and at least two (2) members from another university.</li></ul>                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>THESIS DEFENSE</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Students who are not successful in their defense;</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Will be dismissed from the university.</li></ul> <b>If thesis jury requires revisions;</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>MS students should re-defend the thesis within 3 months and the PhD students within 6 months. If unsuccessful in the 2nd attempt the students will be <u>dismissed</u> from the university.</li><li>If requested by the student and approved by EYK student may opt to get a non-thesis MS degree in fulfilling the degree requirements.</li></ul> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | *Once the advisor approves that the thesis defense can be defended then the student must submit the soft copy of the thesis defense to GSSE.<br>*GSSE must upload the thesis to turnitin and send the report to the advisor and to the thesis jury members.<br>* Detailed information about the thesis defense can be found <a href="#">here</a> .                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| MS with Thesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with MS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| PhD with BS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |